

GS Delivery – qTest Master Test Plan Suite: How-To Guide



Purpose

This page explains **how every QA team member should create, manage, and maintain manual test cases** inside the new **Master Test Plan Suite** in qTest.

It replaces the old release-based or user-based folder model with a clean, feature-based structure that is reusable, traceable, and automation-ready.

No one should use the *ARCHIVAL* folders except for reference.
All new or updated work must follow this process.

1. Where to Work

- **Project:** *GS Delivery – Manual Test Repository*
- **Folder:** MD-13301 – Master Test Plan Suite
- **Do Not Use:** MD-15934 – ARCHIVAL (read-only reference only)

2. How to Add or Update Test Cases

A. When creating a new test case

1. Navigate to **Master Test Plan Suite Platform Module Sub-Module**.
(Example: *Unite 529 Registration IDP Member Registration*)
2. Check if a similar test already exists.
 - If **yes**, reuse or update the existing test case.
 - If **no**, create a **new test case** under the correct functional folder.
3. Use the naming convention:
[Feature] – [Type] – [Short Description]
e.g., Withdrawals – CSR – Positive – NYD – ACH
4. Fill mandatory fields:
 - **Branding** – Select “All” or plan name (e.g., NewYork).
 - **Feature** – Module or function name.
 - **Type** – Manual / Automation / Performance / End-to-End.
 - **Automation Status** – “Automated”, “Need Automation”, or “Will Not Automate”.
5. Tag appropriately for reporting: @regression @smoke @manual @automated @ue @plan_nyd

B. When an existing test case is out of sync

1. Review the latest behavior for that functionality.
2. Update the existing steps or data; **do not duplicate** the test case.
3. Save and version it properly (use *qTest Versioning*).
4. Notify the QA Module Owner for peer review.

C. When reusing test cases for a release

1. Locate the Master test case(s).
2. **Clone or link** them into the appropriate release execution folder.
3. Never edit Master cases directly for release-specific changes.
4. If your release has extra validation steps:
 - Add a note in your cloned test case under *Comments* “Additional Validation Steps”.
 - Keep the main Master case clean and reusable.

D. When functionality changes

1. Identify which shared tests (e.g., *Login, Registration*) are impacted.
2. Update the shared test case once in the Master Suite.
3. Mention the update in the **Change Log** comment.
4. Ensure all related test cases using this shared logic remain valid.

3. Folder Structure Recap

```
Master Test Plan Suite
  Astro
    CSR
    Employer Portal
    Employee Portal
  Unite
    529
      Registration
      Account Update
      Withdrawals
    Able
    Entity Management
  Universal Platform
    Registration
    Account Update
    UE Enrollment
```

Each feature folder may include plan-specific subfolders (e.g., NYD, MID, AKB).

4. Approval & Ownership

Action	Who to Contact / Approver
New folder request or structure change <i>apart from Master test suite</i>	QA Governance Group: Nick, Santiago, Sree Pallavi, Swapnil, Pramod
Feature coverage clarification	Module SME or QA Lead
Master suite maintenance	Assigned QA Module Owner
Release execution issues	Respective Scrum QA or Test Lead

5. Data Queries and Reporting

Use the following qTest data queries to monitor activity and compliance:

To identify new test cases created in the old ARCHIVAL folder:

```
Module in 'MD-15934 *ARCHIVAL*' AND Created Date > '10/01/2025'
```

To identify valid test cases created in the Master Suite:

```
Module in 'MD-13301 *Master Test Plan Suite*' AND Created Date > '10/01/2025'
```

6. Best Practices

Always create by **feature/functionality**, not by release or team.

Use **versioning** instead of copy-paste.

Keep shared modules clean and reusable.

Link test cases to JIRA stories or automation tags.

Use **Execution Folders** only for running tests.

Never copy Master test cases across modules.

Never create plan-specific logic in shared cases.

7. When in Doubt

- **Check the Confluence parent page** for examples and folder visuals.
- **Ask in the QA Forum** before creating new modules.
- **Reach out to Nick (Owner)** for structure clarification.
- **Contact QA Governance Group** for exceptions or approvals.

Summary

*All manual test cases must be created, updated, and maintained under the **Master Test Plan Suite**.
The Archival folders are read-only.
Reusability, traceability, and modular design are mandatory for all GS Delivery QA work.*

Reference Links

- [GS Delivery – qTest Folder Reorganization Plan \(Parent Page\)](#)
- *qTest Project:* [GS Delivery](#) [Master Test Plan Suite](#)